

Cyber Kill Chain

4/18/26

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1. **Reconnaissance** Attacker gathers information about the target (emails, employees, vulnerabilities, network layout). *Why it matters:* The more they know, the better they can plan.
2. **Weaponization** Attacker creates or packages the malware (e.g., embeds exploit in a PDF or builds a malicious document). *Why it matters:* Turns research into an actual weapon.
3. **Delivery** Attacker sends the weapon to the victim (phishing email, malicious link, USB, etc.). *Why it matters:* This is the first time the victim is exposed.
4. **Exploitation** The weapon triggers a vulnerability (e.g., opens malicious document that runs code). *Why it matters:* Gains initial code execution on the system.
5. **Installation** Malware installs itself on the system (persistence, backdoor). *Why it matters:* Ensures the attacker can return later.
6. **Command and Control (C2)** Malware phones home to attacker's server for instructions. *Why it matters:* Attacker now remotely controls the compromised system.
7. **Actions on Objectives** Attacker achieves their goal (data theft, ransomware, destruction, lateral movement). *Why it matters:* This is the actual damage phase.